PATIN / TERO!

SECTION 8 — USER INTERFACE AND USER EXPERIENCE (UI/UX)

Game Design Document | Reconstructed Draft v1.0 | Review edition

Section 8 defines interface structure, player interactions, screen layouts, camera presentation, and usability requirements. The experience follows Plan → Watch → Adapt. Two persistent slightly isometric 3D arenas remain visible during planning and battle, minimizing disruptive transitions.

8.1 UI/UX Design Philosophy

The interface makes tactical decisions clear while preserving 3D battlefield readability. Priorities: clarity over decoration; direct unit manipulation; persistent spatial context; predictable invalid-action handling; minimal interruption; transparent deterministic programming; consistent colors, icons, and UI states.

8.2 Target Platform and Input

Property	MVP specification
Platform / engine	Windows PC / Godot 4
Input	Mouse and keyboard
Reference / minimum resolution	1920×1080 / 1280×720
Orientation / view	Landscape / slightly isometric 3D
Mobile / controller	Outside MVP

Mouse interaction covers selecting, dragging, buying, inspecting, and equipping. Keyboard shortcuts may accelerate common actions, but all essential actions must be mouse-accessible.

8.3 Overall Screen Architecture

Main Menu → Survival League or Practice/Replay → Persistent Dual-Arena Scene (Planning → Battle → Results → Standings) → Tournament Results / Champion. Reuse the tournament arena scene across phases rather than rebuilding the environment.

8.4 Persistent Dual-Arena Layout

Two 4×8 arenas appear side by side. The left arena is the player’s offense (runners versus opposing guards during battle); the right is defense (guards versus opposing runners). Both retain the same placement and framing throughout a session. Overlays may cover portions of the screen, but the arena scene remains loaded.

Layout regions

Top HUD: round, phase, coins, points, and optional timer. Center: offense and defense 3D arenas. Lower region: nine-slot bench and contextual selection. Actions: Shop, Movesets, Preview, and Ready. Conceptual arrangement only; final geometry must be tested at 1280×720.

8.5 Planning Phase Interface

Show round, optional remaining time, coins, tournament points, both arenas, bench, deployed units, shop, moveset editor, preview, and Ready. Players can edit until their setup is locked. After lock, all gameplay-affecting controls become unavailable.

8.6 Character Deployment

Deploy directly to valid anchors. Runners use designated starting anchors; horizontal guards occupy assigned horizontal patrol lines; center guards occupy the central vertical line. At most three runners, three horizontal guards, and one center guard may be active. Each anchor holds at most one eligible character.

Drag workflow: select unit → highlight valid anchors → show drag preview → show valid hover indicator → release to place. An invalid release restores the prior valid position and briefly communicates the reason; no unit is lost.

8.7 Character Selection and Inspection

Clicking a unit opens a contextual panel showing name, role, star level, equipped cards, card capacity, and bench/deployed status. A visible outline or ground ring distinguishes the selected unit from the arena background.

8.8 Signature Moveset Editor

Each character owns three signature cards of four commands each. One-, two-, and three-star units equip respectively one, two, or three distinct cards. Equipped cards execute in player-defined order and loop during battle. Drag-and-drop reorders the cards; duplicate card selection on one unit is prohibited.

Show command shorthand with explanatory tooltips: for example F = Forward, T = runner TAUNT, C = guard SCARE. Illustrative sequence: Card 1 [F, F, DL, F] → Card 2 [L, F, DR, S] → Repeat. This is an interface example, not finalized character data.

8.9 Shop Interface

The shop is a planning-only modal with five character offers and a reroll costing two coins. Each offer shows portrait, name, role, cost, and affordability. Purchases validate coin balance and bench capacity before changing roster state. Reroll replaces all five offers. Underlying arena interactions are blocked while the modal is open; the arenas remain visible behind it. Shop is unavailable during battle and championship restrictions.

8.10 Bench Interface

Display nine bench slots with clear occupied/empty states, unit identity, and star level. Permit selection and dragging. Three identical same-star units may merge; present brief feedback and the resulting star level. Reject purchases that cannot be accommodated or legally merged; never silently discard a character.

8.11 Preview System

Preview one selected unit’s equipped sequence on the existing arena while other units remain inactive unless an expanded preview explicitly allows interaction. Provide Start, Stop, and Reset. Restore pre-preview positions and avoid mutating tournament state. Highlight the current command where practical. Label preview as movement-only, not a guaranteed full-battle prediction.

8.12 Ready and Formation Lock

Before locking, validate required deployments, anchor occupancy, card assignments, star-based capacities, and other match prerequisites. Locked state disables dragging, shopping, editing, and previews. If a planning timer is added, show remaining time prominently; duration and auto-lock behavior remain open decisions.

8.13 Battle Phase Interface

Both arenas simulate simultaneously. Display participant identifiers, arena labels, round, elapsed/progress time, movement, tags, round trips, and arena resolutions. Opponent units become visible in the relevant arenas when battle begins. All gameplay edits are disabled; outcomes come only from locked configurations and authoritative simulation.

8.14 Battle Feedback and Visual Effects

Event	Recommended feedback
Runner / guard movement	Clear directional animation and patrol motion
Tag	Brief impact and tagged state
TAUNT / SCARE	Distinct readable ability effect
Round trip	Success highlight
Arena victory	Result banner
Invalid command	Subtle no-movement indication

Effects must never obscure grid lines, unit positions, or the meaning of a command.

8.15 Camera Design

Use a stable, slightly isometric camera framing both 4×8 boards and all anchors. Patrol lines and center guard lane must be distinct; character occlusion should be minimized. Camera motion must not change the meaning of directional commands. Optional zoom or minor adjustment may be added; free rotation is not required for MVP.

8.16 Results Interface

Show offense and defense outcomes, match score, earned tournament points, coin rewards, round-trip statistics, updated standings, and replay access. Use the same HUD visual language as planning and battle.

8.17 Standings and Elimination Interface

Show rank, player name, tournament points, relevant tiebreakers, active/eliminated status, and current elimination cutoff. Only show elimination after authoritative standings finalize. When two players remain, present the championship and clearly communicate that the shop is disabled.

8.18 Replay Viewer Interface

Reuse the 3D arena presentation with Play, Pause, Restart, and Return. Optional playback speed, scrubbing, and command inspection may follow. Replay controls cannot change recorded results.

8.19 Main Menu

Provide Play Survival League, Practice (if included), Replay Viewer (if available), Settings, and Exit Game. Keep the minimalist game identity; a decorative Patintero grid is acceptable if menu readability remains strong.

8.20 Settings Menu

Category	Settings
Display	Resolution, fullscreen/windowed
Graphics	Quality preset if needed
Audio	Master, music, SFX
Controls	Bindings and relevant sensitivity
Accessibility	UI scale, color distinctions

Persist applicable settings between sessions.

8.21 Visual Language and UI Styling

Recommended colors: teal #3D807B (primary), coral #E97855 (opponent), gold #E9BA54 (rewards), charcoal #263B40 (panels). These are proposals, not finalized branding. Use readable sans-serif body text, reserving decorative lettering for the logo/headings. Icons should have consistent weight and distinct silhouettes; do not convey critical states by color alone.

8.22 Accessibility and Usability

Keep text legible at 1280×720, prevent overlapping panels, retain arena labels, distinguish roles by shape and text, and provide command tooltips. Avoid red/green-only coding. Every essential action needs mouse access, obvious drag feedback, and safe cancellation.

8.23 Godot 4 UI Implementation Structure

Suggested scene tree: TournamentScene (Node3D) → ArenaRoot (OffenseArena, DefenseArena), CameraRig, ArenaInteractionController, UI (CanvasLayer: TournamentHUD, BenchPanel, ShopModal, CharacterInfoPanel, MovesetEditor, PreviewControls, BattleHUD, ResultsPanel, StandingsPanel).

UI nodes display state and submit requests to authoritative game systems; they do not decide merges, shop transactions, scoring, or battle results. Update views via signals such as coin_changed, shop_refreshed, unit_selected, deployment_changed, formation_locked, battle_started, arena_resolved, and standings_updated.

8.24 UI State Management

Component	Planning	Battle	Results
Arena	Visible	Visible	Optional backdrop
Deployment / movesets	Enabled	Disabled	Disabled
Shop	Available*	Disabled	Disabled
Preview	Enabled	Disabled	Disabled
Battle HUD	Hidden	Visible	Hidden
Results	Hidden	Hidden	Visible
Standings	Viewable	Limited	Viewable

*Shop unavailable in championship-restricted planning. Phase validation must block invalid actions regardless of UI appearance.

8.25 UI/UX Testing Guidelines

• Check offense/defense distinction, anchor visibility, and predictable drag/drop with safe invalid-drop recovery.

• Check star capacity, card execution order, shop affordability, full bench behavior, and preview limitations.

• Check readability of movement, tagging, TAUNT/SCARE, round trips, and arena outcomes without pausing.

• Check results, tiebreakers, elimination cutoff, 1280×720 usability, and mouse/keyboard access.

• Check all displayed values remain synchronized with authoritative state.

8.26 MVP Acceptance Criteria

• Two persistent side-by-side 3D arenas stay loaded during planning and battle.

• Valid select/drag/deploy/undeploy and safe invalid-drop behavior; nine-slot bench works.

• Five-offer shop modal and two-coin reroll function with validation.

• Unit info, star levels, card equipping/reordering, and capacity rules are visible and enforced.

• Single-unit preview starts/stops/resets; valid formations lock; editing is disabled in battle.

• Both arenas are readable; results, points, standings, elimination, and available replay controls work.

• Interface supports 1920×1080 and 1280×720; all authoritative actions are validated.

Review — Items Requiring Confirmation

Design item	Status
Windows / Godot 4 / mouse + keyboard	Confirmed
Two persistent slightly isometric 4×8 arenas	Confirmed
Fixed anchors / nine-slot bench / five shop offers	Confirmed
Reroll cost	Confirmed: 2 coins
Contextual moveset editor / single-unit preview	Established
Reference and minimum resolution	Established: 1920×1080 / 1280×720
Planning timer / automatic lock	To be confirmed
Keyboard shortcuts / final palette and typography	To be finalized
Advanced replay controls	Optional
Controller / mobile	Outside MVP